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The Catholic Charismatic Renewal Movement in the United States : A Reconsideration

En se référant au concept de « routinisation », l'Auteur de cet article met en question le caractère absolu et automatique de ce processus selon lequel le mouvement du renouveau charismatique serait appelé à s'institutionnaliser de la même manière que les autres mouvements religieux.

C'est au départ d'une étude de cas que l'Auteur reconsidère le problème : les processus de changement qui ont affecté l'équipe centrale d'une communauté charismatique ont amené celle-ci à décider la scission de la communauté initiale ; c'est donc en termes structurels que le mouvement s'avère capable de faire face au phénomène de la routinisation du charisme.

The emergence in the United States in 1967 of the Catholic Charismatic Renewal (CCR) movement and its subsequent growth have been amply documented by sociological *outsiders* as well as by participating *insiders* who seem anxious to explain what is going on.¹ Within the ranks of sociologists there seems to have developed considerable consensus around several different themes which bear repeating.

Origins and Nature

The movement began in the early part of 1967 at Duquesne University in Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania, among lay faculty and students who reported having been filled with the Holy Spirit. Within a few months it had spread, via networks of friendship, to the University of Notre Dame, at South Bend, Indiana, and on to Michigan State University at East

¹ The bibliography cites most of the available work by sociologists in the United States. Only some of it is cited in the body of the paper but I am indebted to all of my sociological colleagues whose research and analysis has contributed to this paper. The thesis that the CCR ought to be reconsidered and the case study research and analysis are entirely my own. The only citations referring to insiders are those of Ford, O'Connor, Clark, the Ranaghans, and Cavnar, although there is much more available.

Lansing and the University of Michigan at Ann Arbor. Its growth rate since then has been geometric in the United States and in many other countries. Although there are no accurate estimates of total membership, several thousand prayer groups are known to exist in the United States alone. Its annual conventions at South Bend have drawn as many as 40,000 participants, which suggests a very large constituency. The addition of international conferences and, in 1977, a well-publicized interdenominational meeting at Kansas City, Missouri, are indicators of the movements pervasiveness. The Kansas City meeting was, indeed, a media event, largely because of its ecumenical flavor and the attendance of such luminaries as President Carter's sister, Jean Stapleton. It is certainly safe to say that it has been the single most important movement to have emerged within Roman Catholicism in the years since Vatican II.

The reasons for its appearance and rapid growth in the United States have been tied to events which coincided in the 1960's. On the one hand, Vatican II seems to have served as a stimulus among Roman Catholics for the kind of enthusiastic renewal which is identified with CCR. At the same time neo-Pentecostalism was making itself felt in the American Protestant denominational mainstream. Unlike classic Pentecostalism, which had originated at the beginning of this century in Topeka, Kansas, at a fundamentalist bible school, neo-Pentecostal and Catholic Charismatic Renewal members are drawn from the middle class and there is no attempt to convert people to a new sect. The sociological literature frequently reiterates the point that the CCR is a movement, expressive rather than instrumental.

This view of the CCR accords with the generally held sociological position that religious movements in the United States have been expressive. The *born again Christians* who have come into prominence with the Carter administration are, in a sense, simple extensions of the religious *Great Awakenings* of the 18th and 19th centuries. Social observers have remarked on the endemic quality of spiritual revivals in the United States as responses to conditions of social upheaval and cultural dislocation.

The American Background

Vatican II happened at a most peculiar time in the history of the American society in general and of American Catholicism in particular. World War II had been a watershed in many senses of the word. The 1950's were a time of what appeared to be special fulfillment both for the society and for the church. Optimism was most certainly the keynote, the mood was definitely up-beat. If the promise of the American century had been in doubt during the Great Depression before the war, the major institutions of the society, family, economy, polity, educational and religious enterprises, seem to have taken on added strength in spite of those who had predicted, hopefully or not, their demise. The war in Korea had never been popular, but, on the other hand, it had not

pricked the public conscience or aroused emotional resistance as Vietnam eventually would.

The rosy glow of optimism had not been dimmed as the society moved into the 1960's. The election of John F. Kennedy was perceived as a victory not only for Catholics but a reaffirmation of important elements in the American society. Robert Bellah, for example, has made much of his inaugural speech as a benchmark in the unfolding of the American *Civil Religion*. This conforms with Pin's characterization in an earlier issue of *Social Compass*, which was devoted almost entirely to Catholic pentecostalism, of the years up to the mid-60's as triumphalist as far as the church in the United States was concerned.

The ensuing years were ones of disenchantment not only in the realm of the secular but, perhaps most especially, for those who, in Clifford Geertz's apt phrase, see everything from the "religious perspective." There is abundant evidence that those most deeply involved in the CCR, particularly in the ranks of the leadership, have consistently sought solutions to ongoing problems of alienation through action in the religious arena. For example, the Cursillo background of leadership at both national and local levels of the CCR has been noted by a number of observers. The thrust of such solutions clearly has not been in terms of political activism. As Fichter (1975, p. 144) has put it: "The goal of the renewal movement is personal spiritual reform, not organized social reform, but this does not imply the absence of social concern. The movement's basic conviction is that a better society can emerge only when people have become better, yet it would be completely erroneous to interpret this as an individualistic and self-centered attitude."

The Political Impact of the Movement

Although there seems to be essential agreement among sociological observers that the movement is neither "individualistic" nor "self-centered," it has been misinterpreted as giving aid and comfort, so to speak, to conservative political positions. As long ago as 1965, when neo-Pentecostalism had just begun to diffuse itself throughout the mainline Protestant denominations in the United States, a perceptive observer cautioned that there was a tendency to confuse the religious fundamentalism of the pentecostals with radical right wing political movements (Elinson, 1965). Members of right wing movements are *politically* active while pentecostals *evangelize*. If the action emphasis among the former is on elections and legislation as means of stemming the tide of secularism, that of the pentecostals has been in the direction of personal reformation as a strategy for waging the same battle. Both may be in agreement that the current social order is breaking down, that the prevailing social and political institutions are in a state of crisis, but clearly the panaceas offered are of quite a different order.

Even though Elison's paper was concerned with members of the classic or traditional Pentecostal religions which had been flourishing for about half a century among the lower and lower-middle socio-economic grou-

pings in the United States, his findings have been substantiated by those in the decade or so since who have been looking at neo-Pentecostals and Catholic Charismatics. Fichter, for example, has documented the wide range of social and political attitudes characteristic of his national sample. The general sociological consensus seems to have been that, as the movement is essentially appealing to the middle class, its membership is representative of the liberal-conservative spectrum of that wider class from which it is drawn. There is little evidence that the bulk of American Catholics, of course, depart from this middle class mainstream. This is not to say that the Catholic Charismatic Renewal, neo-Pentecostalism, and the wide range of evangelical movements, most of whom met together at the Kansas City meeting mentioned above, have no identifiable political significance. They simply must be understood as part of the woop-and-warf of the American political scene in which middle-of-the-road, middle class pragmatism is seen not as compromise with reactionary or conservative political movements, since they offer no political reformist platforms, but as the triumph of virtues embedded in the American Civil Religion.

To the extent that the development of the CCR accords with this description, then it would be safe to predict that, regardless of current levels of enthusiasm engendered by it and other *born again* impulses, it will become routinized in the same fashion as earlier religious movements in the United States, so that even when sects have emerged they have become established. An intervening set of events, however, to which *insiders* have been sensitive, suggests that a structural alternative within the movement may, in fact, force sociologists to take a second look and to reevaluate the direction of routinization.

A Structural Shift

Most sociological studies of CCR have called attention to, and the insiders consciously foster, the distinction between core members and those who attend the weekly prayer meetings. The latter may, in reality be as pious or as committed to the pentecostal experience as core members, but they are peripheral to the active maintenance of the movement at the local or national level. Their concerns, in short, are really not organizational. Core members are, for the most part, occupied with the question of the framework within which personal spiritual reform will take place. What follows is a case study of developments within the core group in a single charismatic community. Following on its presentation an attempt will be made to assess its significance.

In March, 1977, the leadership of the John the Baptist Renewal Community, which had been the locus of an earlier study (Lane, 1972 and 1976), issued a press release announcing that the community would cease operation in San Francisco and that plans were underway to move the bulk of the core members to join the People of Praise community in South Bend, Indiana. The announcement was the culmination of a series of events which had beset this particular community. However,

these events are of sociological interest because they are symptomatic of a more widespread conflict in the 10 year old Catholic Charismatic Renewal movement in the United States.

John the Baptist community had been formed in early 1970, apparently the first in the San Francisco Bay Area, by some persons who had studied at Notre Dame. Although it has retained considerable influence in the ensuing years as a kind of regional "mother church," its own core group of members had reached a numerical plateau early on, or at least grew at a decelerating rate after the first flush of success. At least a year before the March, 1977, announcement, and probably for a longer period according to informants' accounts, strains had been developing as a result of positions with respect to future directions taken by those in upper echelons of leadership and influence in the community. The split was occurring along the lines described in a recent work by J. Massyngherde Ford (1976). Ford, herself, had been an active member of the Notre Dame community and a member of that University's theology faculty. Her account of the split is quite partisan, since she plainly allies herself with Type II, but as descriptive categories the typology is workable. Those whom Ford would classify as Type II have a more accommodative posture vis-à-vis the church as an institution as well as the institutions of the wider society; those in her Type I appear to be more critical of the society and, most especially, of what they see as a very serious decline in the influence of the post-Vatican II church. As a consequence, the latter advocate the formation of covenanted communities, i.e., communities which live according to a rule and which are more insulated from the surrounding milieu. Views on the form of authority, the nature of ecumenism, the role of women, and a number of other issues are also at stake, but the relationship to the world is more relevant both to this paper and to general sociological concerns.

To begin to put the San Francisco developments into perspective, it should be said that the seeds for the split were sewn within the movement early in its development. Thus, even if the factionalism did not break out in the open in San Francisco until the last few years, this is not to say that it had not been emerging much earlier. The San Francisco community must have been influenced by developments at Ann Arbor and South Bend, with both of which it maintained close personal ties in the reticulate form observed to be characteristic of the movement. So many of the *founding fathers* or elder statesmen of the movement have been located in both those communities that they have nourished an elite which, despite considerable controversy surrounding it, has steadfastly maintained what may be described as a radical set of Type I prescriptions with respect to church reform. They have argued for the formation of communities effectively insulated but not isolated from the influence of the secular society, to use a distinction employed by Brian Wilson (1959).

In reaction to the intense, exclusivist or closed character of these communities there is pressure within the movement for more accommodative positions to be voiced. One indicator of this is the emergence in 1975 of a new national publication, *Catholic Charismatic*, published by the Paulist Press and containing articles more frequently authored by clergy

and by persons outside the movement who may have inspirational comments to make. In the view of Type II informants in San Francisco this publication serves as an effective antidote to *New Covenant*, which has been the "official" movement publication for half a dozen years. It comes out of Ann Arbor and tends to reflect the Type I line.

In late 1976 and early 1977 the perception on the part of some of the leaders that the San Francisco community was not growing in numbers and that disunity over goals and other issues as well had interfered with potential growth, in the qualitative sense as a cohesive community, led the leaders to earnest discussion among themselves. These discussions were accompanied with an intensification of prayer, individually and collectively, seeking "guidance from the Lord" to help them *discern* the direction the community ought to take.

A word should be said here about the importance the leadership attaches to discernment as a decision making process, inspired, as they see it, by the Holy Spirit. They take very seriously what they consider to be their *election* as leaders and are concerned with the problem of their own legitimacy. After all, it reflects in turn on the legitimacy of the decisions they make in the name of the entire community.

At no time was this striving for legitimacy and normality more evident than in a discussion with one informant about the circumstances surrounding the specific decision to move the entire community the 2000 miles from San Francisco to South Bend. The prayers and discussions among the leaders, initially inchoate, rapidly coalesced, as the informant recalls, around the possibility of leaving San Francisco and moving either to Ann Arbor or to South Bend. The first person to broach the subject prefaced his remarks with: "You may think this is off the wall, but...". All apparently agreed that such a move might seem too extreme or radical a solution to what they felt were becoming insoluble problems within the community. Nevertheless they consented to reflect on the idea and to pray over it further.

One of the indicators, to those engaged in discerning, that an idea's time has come or that a proposed course of action has the blessing of the Lord is the effect they have on participants. If they create personal or collective discord then they probably are not from the Lord. In this case, after a few days' prayer and reflection among the leaders, or at least among those who had been expressing dissatisfaction with the state of affairs in the John the Baptist Renewal Community, the idea of the move seemed increasingly attractive and appropriate to them. Correspondence and telephone conversations with persons of influence in the Ann Arbor and South Bend communities played a positive role in the discerning process. Since they, too, seemed fairly receptive to and encouraging of the move, this was interpreted, according to the informant, as a reinforcing sign that the move would have the Lord's blessing.

The specific choice of South Bend appears to have been made in terms of what the leaders perceived as both a push and a pull. There is an immediately recognizable methodological difficulty in accepting at face value the validity of any informant's *ex post facto* reconstruction.

This would seem especially the case where the leaders, even by their own admission, are attempting to legitimize their decisions in the face of considerable opposition. The point here, though, is not so much whether the reconstruction assembles all the relevant facts or includes dissenting points of view. Rather, the content of reconstruction affords clues with respect to what leaders perceive as important elements in decision making. In short, what did the leaders think was pushing them out of San Francisco and what did they feel was pulling them to South Bend?

With respect to the push, there are several items, one of which refers to Ford's Type I-Type II distinction and the split which had developed in the John the Baptist Renewal Community along these lines. Those Ford would classify as Type I are, in the San Francisco case and most probably elsewhere, lay *men* who had been in leadership roles in the prayer group right from the beginning. Initially they had worked closely with members of religious orders, one of whom was liaison to the local ordinary. At least a year, and probably longer as indicated, before the move the lay men were pressing more and more for the transformation of the core members of the prayer group into a more identifiable community which, as indicated above, would be governed by a covenant or rule. The latter would be comparable to that which obtains in religious orders and had already been achieved at Ann Arbor and South Bend and, presumably, at other places. These lay leaders were willing to go on providing the weekly prayer meeting as a kind of "spiritual service station," but they saw the mission of the core group as creation and maintenance of a community in which members could have more total involvement in each other's lives.

Type II persons, predominantly though not exclusively from clerical ranks, argued for the centrality of the prayer meetings and the spin-off educational and inspirational activities which from Ford's point of view are, at once, much more "... flexible and less structured," and more "... fully integrated with the theology and sacramentality of the contemporary Catholic church..." Type I participants fear that if, the maintenance of the Saturday night prayer meetings becomes the chief function served by the core group, their energies will be directed to preserving the modern equivalents of novenas, benediction, and other devotional activities which were pervasive in pre-conciliar days.

Furthermore, from the Type I perspective, the Type II position lends itself to cooptation by the going ecclesiastical institutional structures. This is a crucial issue both in terms of authority and the way in which communities can be structured. We will return to this, but suffice to say here that Type I leaders are suspicious of just where clerical loyalties lie. That clerics, at least in the San Francisco case, seemed more ready to espouse the Type II position is seen by Type I persons as further testimony of the correctness of their suspicions.

Not only was there the influence of the Type II advocates which was felt to make difficult the creation of a covenanted community, but residential propinquity is difficult to achieve given the economics of home buying in the San Francisco Bay Area. Having housing adjacent to one

another is seen as a necessary, though clearly not sufficient, condition for creating a communal cluster of couples, their children, and single persons who either share quarters among themselves or live with community couples. As it turned out, the same difficulty did not present itself in the South Bend area. In fact, prior to moving at the beginning of the summer of 1977, there had been purchased or there were plans to buy housing in a single neighborhood which, it was hoped, might accommodate the 80 or so adults and their children who were expected to go to South Bend. This, of course, was one of the pull factors and was interpreted, according to one informant, as a further sign of the rightness of the decision to move.

Attention has been given to this matter of housing to underscore the earlier remarks with relation to discernment. It is a process, as has been intimated, which hinges on ordinary, mundane events for supportive evidence not the least important of which, in a secular world, is economic feasibility. In the same vein, consideration had been given to the relative merits of Ann Arbor as over against South Bend. The sheer size of the Ann Arbor community, now somewhat over 1000 persons living in a fairly close community, was judged to be less able to absorb in any meaningful way the San Francisco transplants. The South Bend community has no more than 400 persons and was deemed more flexible in accepting an influx of persons needing jobs and housing.

The final push factor was asserted to be the secular character or ambience of San Francisco, which was interpreted in the words of a Type I informant as militating against the formation of a Christian community. This conforms with the idea expressed in a recent editorial in *New Covenant* that "... modern secularism is the real opiate of the people." This as a rationale for the move deserves some comment since it is presumably a view of the world shared by all involved in religious renewal, charismatic or otherwise. What merits attention here is the consequent prescription for action. In opposition to secularization it calls for a strategic withdrawal from the place in which efforts to create a sense of Christian community have fallen on fallow, or, perhaps, hostile ground. This would seem to represent a major departure from the general way in which American Catholics have confronted the world around them. Even while the faithful were being warned at the beginning of the century about the dangers of Modernism and the Americanist tendencies were being denounced, clergy and laity alike were fully engaged in assimilating themselves to the mainstream.

It is not a matter, of course, of whether South Bend really affords a more salubrious spiritual climate than San Francisco. Without intending to indulge in civic rivalry, it is hard to believe that it does. Its pull in this case is a question of the kind of milieu it is perceived to have by those leaving San Francisco, in terms of the kind of life they are trying to construct for themselves. The economic feasibility of residential propinquity has already been mentioned as an element important to them in realizing the milieu. The shared experience of leaving San Francisco and attempting to build a community in South Bend presumably, in itself, should go a long way to creating and sustaining

the sought for feeling of community. In that sense, South Bend, as such, is not important, even though it has been a vital national center of the CCR.

Those moving from San Francisco have fully expected to be caught up in staffing service functions provided for the movement nationwide and abroad through organizational offices in South Bend, which work in close cooperation with Ann Arbor. For some of the San Francisco group this literally would be a source of gainful employment. For others it would be a focus of activity which could become the basis of that desired shared experience with a larger number than exists in San Francisco.

This latter factor seems central to understanding both push and pull for it suggests that these active charismatics have been in search of a specially insulated locus in which they can act out their commitment. This is quite a different impulse than that of the Type II members who have remained behind. These latter should be divided into two groups, clergy who were more or less formally excluded from moving by the Type I leadership, and the laity who either chose not to go or were discouraged by those planning the move. In both cases, from the Type I perspective and, probably, from their own as well, the move would have created ambiguities for them and would have affected the coherence of the group. Harrison (1974b) employed the notion of competing commitment as an important variable to account for those who would be recruited initially to the pentecostal experience and to the CCR. He suggested that those whose life was characterized by competing commitments, such as careers, marriage, more settled life style, would be the least likely to be recruited. The same phenomenon appears to be at work here. The kind of community which Type I persons have in mind involves commitment to the maintenance of the group itself, not just the fellowship of those who share a common cultic experience.

The application to lay persons is fairly obvious. Many are married to persons who, themselves, are not charismatics. Their stake in jobs or home or commitment to friends, a kind of social inertia rather than potential for mobility, may describe their unwillingness to be uprooted and transplanted in search of a new form of community. The case of the clergy is somewhat different, in that it hinges on what the Type I persons see as the conflicting organizational loyalties encountered by the person who owes allegiance to a religious superior. As mentioned above, in the San Francisco case, the Type I leadership doubted that the clergy would be willing or able to choose to submit to their authority.

Assessing the Significance

It is this emphasis on the group at a new organizational level that emerges from this narrative as having the most significant impact of sociological interest. Notice that in South Bend the members are still expecting to be engaged in service maintaining functions. However, the

shift in the organizational level of their endeavors has opened up the possibility of a new organizational form for the group itself, and at the same time it could portend a change in the manner in which the CCR is effective in the church and, ultimately, in the wider society.

Ford is especially concerned with Type I developments in three areas, viz., the structure of the covenanted communities which she views as authoritarian and exclusivist, the relationship to the hierarchical authority of the church which she sees as potentially schismatic, and the apparent lack of social action concern which she feels is essentially un-Christian. Practices with which she was familiar in a covenanted community at True House in South Bend had alarmed her and she has vigorously expressed her concern on many subsequent occasions. She reports that she has been unable to establish communication with the Type I Leadership, intimating their unwillingness to accept informed criticism. The substance of the events involving True House were reported in a series of articles in *National Catholic Reporter* (Casey, 1975). She likens the Type I model to the Anabaptists, the Radical Reformers of the sixteenth century. As partial proof of this assertion, she notes deprecatingly what others have observed, i.e., the influence on Type I charismatics of Benjamin Zablocki's *The Joyful Community*. Yet to understand this influence, it is important to examine the position of the Type I leadership.

Trying to build what they call a Christian community is perceived by them -as an especially perplexing task since there are few readily available models of lay communities which, from their point of view, are applicable to the contemporary world. The experiences of the Bruderhof, as reported by Zablocki (1971), are in some ways paradigmatic. Type I leaders make reference to those experiences precisely because they hope to profit by the difficulties the Bruderhof experienced. The difficulties in forming and maintaining intentional communities are dealt with by Zablocki in a critical fashion which is instructive but, like Kanter's work (1972) on both 19th and 20th century communities, his approach is both sympathetic and optimistic. One suspects that Zablocki's work serves as an unofficial handbook as much because of the encouragement it offers as for the developmental guideposts it might contain.

Without taking sides in the matter, there is no doubt that Type I leaders have felt the necessity for ruthless measures in order to create the tightly knit communities they feel will be viable in the long run. Manuals and tapes produced mainly by prominent spokesmen at Ann Arbor and South Bend, and available from the Communications Center at the latter, frequently address the control problems of the covenanted communities. There is no hidden agenda, so to speak, and their position has been well known for a number of years. It seems likely, if the ambitions imputed to them by one informant are realized, that the Type I leadership imagines the communities can become a new type of religious order, perhaps unthinkable in the pre-conciliar world. They are striving to innovate in what they define as the call for renewal of Vatican II and they feel that only disciplined zealots can survive the pressure which such innovations involve.

The pressure parallels Ford's three areas of concern. First, the covenanted communities face much the same problem of internal control as all religious orders. Having been socialized in a world which puts great emphasis on individual achievement, it is necessary for the recruit to become a *new person* to accede to the authority of the group. Also, since members of the covenanted communities of the CCR work at a variety of daily jobs, frequently unrelated to other community members geographically and functionally, the problem is compounded. From the outside, one is tempted to say that this could produce a daily exercise in schizophrenia for many members unless appropriate modes of socialization to this new situation are worked out. In addition, the fact that some also have the prior affective ties of marriage poses control problems obviously not faced in celibate orders. A few of those who moved to South Bend have returned to San Francisco in the ensuing months. The Type II adherents have sometimes interpreted this to mean that the community in South Bend is failing and that they were right not to go. However much this assuages their feelings, it may be a premature analysis of what will happen. Religious orders have always lost recruits because the postulants have resented the regime imposed upon them or, for one reason or another, have decided it is not for them. Type I leadership is frank in admitting that many of its efforts at control have been heavy handed but they defend them on the grounds of necessary experimentation and their own inexperience. The discerning process goes on among them as a means of ensuring them that they are on the right path.

Second, there is external pressure which centers on the mode in which the covenanted communities will conform to the hierarchical church. Here, again, the Type I leadership has expressed its desire to remain within the fold and to search for new ways in which lay persons can relate to the church. Ford is critical of them because they do not seem agreeable to accepting what they see as the status quo. They are, by her admission, impatient with the pallid lack of initiative of the post-conciliar church. She berates them for shunning clerical guidance, but they choose to be selective about which clerical guidance and at which level. Coleman (1976, p. 26) evaluates the situation quite differently than Ford when he comments: "The story of lay renewal movements in the United States has exhibited a repetitive pattern of fragmentation, loss of vigor and deep ambiguity about whether to focus on an agenda directed toward inner renewal of the church or outer influence on the wider society. This has been true in recent years of both the Cursillo movement and the underground church . . . A rapid mobilization of the laity along socio-expressive lines has, time and again foundered on the shoals of the intransigent parish which results in a sapping sense of the absence of any greater purpose vis-à-vis diocesan or national church goals. One of the exciting *structural* developments in the current Catholic pentecostal movement — I will prescind from any evaluation of the movement in terms of its expressive, religious purposes — is that the movement has, thus far, been able to develop its own semi-autonomous national, regional and diocesan-wide structures under lay leadership and has avoided the trap of being sucked into the fragmenting vortex of the

parish. Several such structurally autonomous lay movements would seem necessary if the American laity is to exert any leverage upon the church in its present crisis.

This brings us to the final area of Ford's concern. Interestingly, she cites Fichter's work as documentation that the CCR has not been sufficiently concerned with social action, although his remarks quoted earlier suggest that he appreciates the dilemma which the movement faces. It is the ambiguity mentioned by Coleman concerning choice of agenda, inner renewal or outer influence on the wider society. The Type I adherents unabashedly opt for the inner renewal, but they have shifted the structural level at which they choose to act. It remains to be seen whether this strategy works. Meanwhile, it seems foolhardy if sociological observers dismiss them for not having accomplished more or different things. The studies by Kanter and by Zablocki suggest that we keep them very much on our research agenda.

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